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Guide:

Students will write, rehearse and perform in class **two examples of troubleshooting interactions, a bad one and a good one**. It will be based on one of the technical problems that we used in the previous session. They are expected to last **around 3 minutes each**.

In the good one, they are expected to...

- Acknowledge the issue and offer reassurance
- Ask clarifying questions
- Reproduce the issue if necessary
- Do relevant and non-intrusive troubleshooting steps
- Stay calm and polite
- Guide the user step by step

This will end up solving the problem to everyone's satisfaction.

In the bad one, some or most of these points will fail, and the interaction will go nowhere and end up in disaster. Additionally, to make things more interesting, each pair will be dealing with **two additional difficulties** selected from a list.

The dialogues will be performed **next week, Wednesday 3rd December**. The scripts will be submitted here, just for reference and for Chati-authorship verification purposes.

Technical difficulty:

Problem: No sound

Hint: "I changed the HDMI cable earlier"

Solution: select the correct audio output device

Additional client problems in both outcomes:

Keeps interrupting the technician

Describes the problem very vaguely

The good one:

Technician: Hello, thank you for calling tech support. My name is Alvaro. How may I assist you today?

Client: Hello, I'm having problems with my computer, and I don't know why. Could you help me solve it, please?

Technician: Could you tell me what kind of problems you are having?

Client: I can't hear anything

Technician: Okay, let me ask you something first-...

Client: Tell me

Technician: Yeah, yeah, I'm trying to do that. Stay calm, please, and please tell me what the problem is that you're experiencing with your computer in a bit more detail.

Client: I don't know exactly; I just know that I can't hear anything from it.

Technician: So, the problem is that you basically can't hear anything at all. Then, this is what we're going to do: I'll ask you a few quick questions, and then-...

Client: Well, come on, ask me the questions then

Technician: Alright, we'll do that right now

Technician: Let's see, first question: Where do you want your audio to be played? Is it in your headphones, your monitor-....?

Client: Yes!! Right there, the monitor! That's it!

Technician: Good! We're getting closer; now we know that it is most likely a monitor-related problem, which can be fixed very easily.

Client: I see...

Technician: Right, another question: You see the contents on your screen, right?

Client: Yes

Technician: Then we know that the problem is not the cable being connected improperly.

Client: Ahhh, ok...

Technician: And you did hear audio from your monitor before, right?

Client: Yes, I always have heard audio from it. I've been using this monitor for five years, and I have never ever had a problem with it. This is the first time that this has happened to me.

Technician: Okay, so the monitor can in fact output audio. So...

Client: Yes, I just said it

Technician: Have you changed anything recently in your monitor or your computer?

Client: The only thing that I can remember I did recently was changing the previous cable because it stopped working, and I could no longer see the screen

Technician: Then, assuming that the new cable that you are using is not broken, we can trace the problem back to the computer. So... First of all, can you check if, in your computer, the current audio output device is set to your monitor? You can check that in your computer's taskbar down below in the bottom right corner

Client: I checked, and I'm currently seeing that it says Realtek 2.

Technician: There it is; we found the problem. To solve it, all you have to do is change that to your monitor output by clicking there and selecting it.

Client: I did it, and it worked; now I'm hearing audio. Thank you so much!

Technician: Perfect, I'm glad it's working correctly now. If you have any other problems in the future, feel free to contact us again!

Client: Okay, will do if that ever happens

Technician: Goodbye!

The bad one

Technician: Hello, thank you for calling tech support. My name is Alvaro. How may I assist you today?

Client: Hi, yeah, my computer is not doing what it should.

Technician: I see. Could you tell me what kind of problem you are having exactly?

Client: Well, it's weird I can't really hear things from it.

Technician: Okay, let me ask a few questions so we can figure this out...

Client: Sure, but please help me resolve this quickly because I need it for work.

Technician: I will try to resolve it as soon as possible. First, where do you want your audio to be played? Headphones, monitor...

Client: Yes, that's it. I'd like to hear it on the monitor

Technician: Good. And you can see your screen fine, right?

Client: Yeah, the screen looks fine. The picture is perfect, so I don't think it's a display issue.

Technician: Great. So it's probably not the cable. Have you heard audio from this monitor before?

Client: Yeah, yeah, before, it worked. It was working just fine until recently.

Technician: Perfect. And have you changed anything recently, like cables...

Client: Yes, I switched the cable a little while ago because my dog is always getting in the way and chewing things. So maybe that?

Technician: Yeah, it's possible the problem is related to that cable change. Can you check your computer's audio output device? Look at the taskbar, bottom right.

Client: Okay, it says Realtek 2

Technician: Ah, that might be the problem. If you select your monitor instead, it should work

Client: I tried that and nothing, can we try another thing?

Technician: Okay, let's try updating your audio driver...

Client: But I don't want to do that; it takes too long. And as I already told you, I don't have much time.

Technician: Alright, then maybe check the volume mixer...

Client: I already checked the mixer. Everything is at maximum, and nothing is muted.

Technician: I see. well, it could also be a hardware issue with the monitor or the port

Client: So, that means I'm stuck?

Technician: Possibly, yes. I wish I could fix it over the phone, but sometimes the problem is with the physical hardware, and software solutions won't work. My recommendation would be to have a technician physically inspect the monitor and cables to determine the exact cause.

Client: Mmm okay, I think that makes sense. It's just frustrating because I really need it for work today.

Technician: I'm sorry we couldn't solve it over the phone. Feel free to call back if anything changes.

Client: Yeah, I'll call you if I have any other problems. Thank you for your help.